

Recipe App UI Research

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1. Introduction

This document outlines the research and design process for a Progressive Web App (PWA) Recipe Manager, aimed at simplifying recipe storage and access. The research includes UI inspiration, competitor analysis, user needs, and color testing to ensure an intuitive and visually appealing experience.

2. UI & UX Research

2.1. Pinterest Board Analysis

To understand the visual trends in cooking apps, I browsed Pinterest for UI inspiration. Key observations:

- Color schemes: Many apps use warm, inviting colors like reds, oranges, and yellows to stimulate appetite.
- Layout trends: Clean, minimalistic interfaces with clear navigation.
- Typography: Readable fonts with a balance between modern and playful aesthetics.

2.2. Competitor Analysis

Examining existing recipe apps helped identify common patterns:

- Strength: Easy navigation, categorized recipes, and user-friendly interfaces.
- Weaknesses: some apps require multiple steps to access saved recipes, leading to frustration.

3. User Needs & Goals

As a student living alone, I needed a way to quickly access saved recipes without navigating through multiple steps on Instagram. The app should:

- Allow manual recipe entry for easy access
- Provide a visually appealing and intuitive UI
- Reduce time spent searching for saved recipes

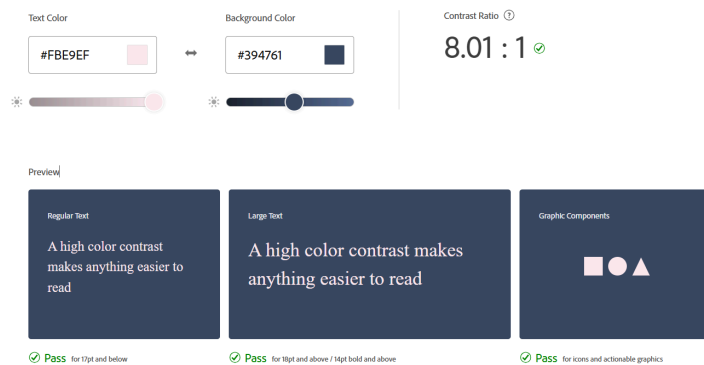
4. Color Testing & Selection

4.1. Testing Process

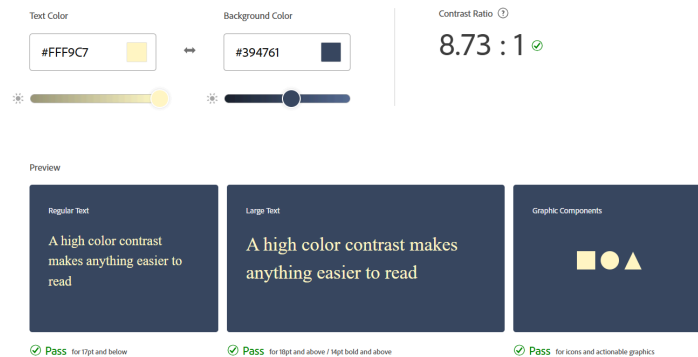
I tested font colors using **Adobe's color contrast tool** to ensure readability and accessibility. The contrast ratio determines whether text is legible against its background, following **WCAG (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines)** standards.

■ Color Choices & Justification

- Pink (#FBE9EF) on a Dark Blue (#394761):
 - Contrast Ratio: 8.01:1 (Passes WCAG AA & AAA for normal and large text)
 - Reasoning: Chosen for personalization; it's my favorite color, adding individuality to the app. The high contrast ensures readability.



- Yellow (#FFF9C7) on Dark Blue (#394761):
 - Contrast Ratio: 8.73:1 (Passes WCAG AA & AAA for normal and large text)
 - Reasoning: Yellow stimulates hunger and complements pink aesthetically. The strong contrast improves visibility and accessibility.



- Dark Blue as Background:
 - Scientific Validation: Dark blue evokes calmness, reliability, and focus, making users feel comfortable while engaging with the app.
 - Contrast Benefits: Provides a strong visual foundation for text elements, ensuring clarity and reducing eye strain.

5. Conclusion & Final Design Direction

5.1. Key Takeaways from Research

- **Simplified Recipe Access:**
Current apps often make retrieving saved recipes frustrating. The new app should prioritize quick access and organization.
- **Minimalist & User-Friendly UI:**
Clean design, clear typography, and simple navigation enhance the user experience.
- **Color Psychology for Engagement:**
Strategic color choices can improve emotional connection, appetite stimulation, and readability.
- **Competitor Weaknesses:**
Some recipe apps lack manual entry options, which limits personalization.

5.2. Final Design Enhancements

Based on these findings, here are key improvements to integrate into the app design:

- **Quick-access Recipe Storage:**
The app should allow an instant search feature or categorized folders.
- **Streamlined Navigation:**
A simplified interface ensures smooth movement between pages, reducing unnecessary steps.
- **Recipe Organization Feature:**
Users should be able to tag, filter, and favorite recipes for better accessibility.
- **Personalized UI Elements:**
A carefully chosen color scheme enhances both aesthetic appeal and usability.